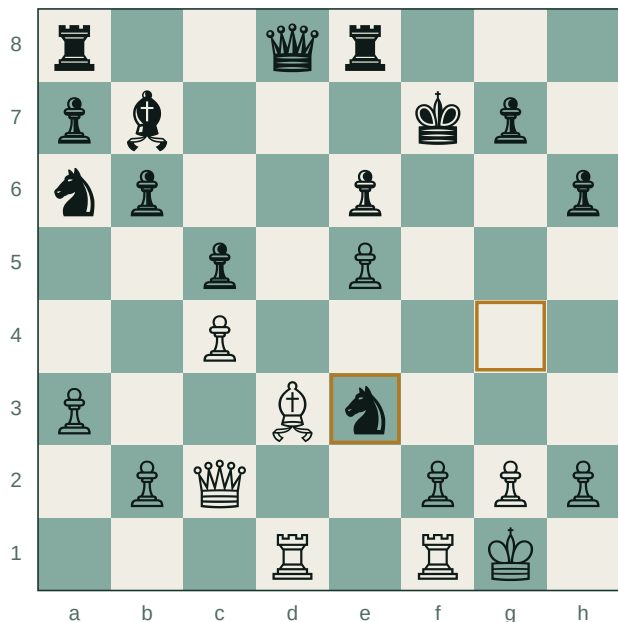


Discovered checks: White, move 17

Discovered checks

White to move



Previous move: 16...Nxe3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17. fxe3+ Kg8 18. Bh7+ Kh8 19. Rxd8

17.fxe3+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on f1 attacks the king on f7. Recorded reply: **17...Kg8**.

18.Bh7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the rook on d1 attacks the queen on d8. Recorded reply: **18...Kh8**.

19.Rxd8 The rook captures the queen on d8. From d8 it attacks rook on e8 and rook on a8.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +12. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +12:** the balance goes from -5 to +7. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on f7. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b7 and knight on e3. Check for tactical protection.